

Ask Cinderhaven — Can I trust my own forecast?

baseline scenario — figures reconcile to Production Demand Forecast

Can I trust my own forecast?

Forecast MAPE is 59.9% — well above the 30% broken threshold. At this error rate, production and procurement decisions made from the forecast will be wrong by a third or more. Worst SKU: Raspberry Chipotle Glaze at 91.8% MAPE. Median error is 60.0% — the problem is systemic, not outlier-driven.

59.9% MAPE — forecast broken

Key numbers

59.9%	Forecast MAPE
60.0%	Median SKU error
	Median of per-SKU MAPEs
Raspberry Chipotle Glaze	Worst SKU
	91.8% MAPE

How this verdict was reached

MAPE computed per SKU: $\text{AVG}(|\text{actual} - \text{forecast}| / \text{actual})$ across active store-weeks. Forecast proxy = `fct_distribution.avg_weekly_units`. Macro-MAPE = average of per-SKU MAPEs across 50 SKUs. Decision-grade: < 20%. Warning: 20–30%. Broken: > 30%.

Go deeper

Production Demand Forecast: <https://lailarallc.com/production-demand-forecast>

Data: Cinderhaven Provisions, a synthetic demonstration dataset (not a client).

Built by Lailara LLC — data hygiene and analytics consulting for specialty food brands scaling into national retail.
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